

EOM — Escalation & Override Module

Canonical Definition

Escalation & Override defines the conditions under which decision authority is elevated, transferred, or overridden to maintain system control under critical or crisis conditions.

A system is not governable if escalation and override mechanisms do not exist or cannot be executed.

Purpose

This module ensures that:

- critical situations trigger controlled escalation
 - authority can transition when required
 - system control can be restored immediately
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Core Principle

If escalation is not defined, failure is uncontrolled.
If override is not possible, control does not exist.

Minimum Implementation Framework (MIF)

The system MUST define:

1. Escalation Triggers

Clear conditions that initiate escalation, including:

- threshold breaches
 - system instability
 - failure conditions
 - high-risk decisions
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2. Authority Transition Rules

The system MUST define:

- who takes control after escalation
 - how authority is transferred
 - when escalation is completed
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3. Maximum Response Time

The system MUST define:

- maximum allowed delay for escalation
 - response time thresholds per decision level
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4. Fallback Authority

The system MUST define:

- backup authority if primary authority is unavailable
 - automatic or manual fallback conditions
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5. Override Mechanism

The system MUST ensure:

- immediate override capability
- ability to stop or reverse actions

For AI-enabled systems:

- human override MUST exist
 - override MUST be enforceable without delay
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Mandatory Conditions

- escalation MUST be triggerable
 - authority transfer MUST be defined
 - override MUST be executable at any time
 - system MUST not remain in uncontrolled state
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Prohibited Conditions

- missing escalation triggers
 - undefined authority transfer
 - delayed or blocked override
 - inability to stop system actions
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Output

The system produces:

Controlled Escalation Flow

Immediate Intervention Capability

System Condition

- **Valid** → escalation and override are active and executable
 - **Invalid** → escalation fails or override is not possible
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Use Case 1 — System Failure Event

Without module:

- failure detected
- no escalation
- delayed response

With module:

- trigger activated
- authority escalated
- response executed

Result:

- failure contained
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Use Case 2 — AI Emergency Override

Without module:

- AI continues harmful execution
- no stop mechanism

With module:

- human override triggered
- execution stopped immediately

Result:

- system control restored
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Closing Insight

If a system cannot escalate, it cannot react.

If it cannot be overridden, it cannot be controlled.

Related Documents

[→ CGRM Standard](#)

[→ CGRM Modules Overview](#)

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Canonical Source

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